Your first session as a caregiver or DSP

This section is for direct support professionals, respite caregivers, family caregivers, and other approved staff who record support.

Set up once

1. Get the STAR link and invite code from your administrator. Complete Step 1, join the group (Step 4), and save your Profile (Step 6).

2. Open Home and confirm that the correct group and individual are shown. If someone is missing, contact the administrator before creating a record.

3. Ask which sections you are assigned in Check-in. A caregiver may have fewer or different questions than another team member.

4. Find Group Chat, Docs, Calendar, Focus, Emergency, Reports, Saved Drafts, and the Feature Guide. Learn where Help Now and Something Hurts alerts appear.

Each shift

1. Open Check-in. Confirm the individual and the service date, especially for a late or backdated entry.

2. Complete assigned sections; record facts, what support you provided, where support occurred, and the individual's own words separately.

3. Save a draft if you are not finished; return through Saved Drafts to submit the entry. Confirm the submission appears in Reports.

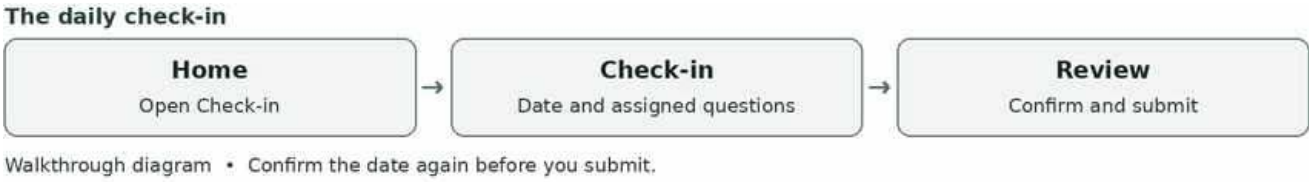
4. If an experience would be meaningful to remember, use Add a Moment with a photo and short label, so the individual can choose their own reaction later.

5. Check Group Chat and the dashboard for relevant team notifications and follow the agreed communication procedure.

SCREENSHOT NEEDED — S09: Caregiver Home after joining, showing the main Quick Actions and the person/group selected.

Caregiver | Complete a daily check-in

For caregivers and direct support staff



Start and submit a check-in

1. From Home, open Check-in and select Begin Check-in if prompted.
2. Check the date. For a late entry, use the date of the support you're documenting. If the screen shows a person selector, confirm who the entry is for.
3. Work through the guided sections that apply. Use Jump to Section if it's available and you want to go directly to a particular topic.
4. Record what you observed and the support you provided. If you include the person's own words, identify them as a quote. Add an ISA answer when the check-in asks for it.

SCREENSHOT NEEDED — S10: Where Support Provided and Location appear in a caregiver check-in.

5. Review the answers and confirm the date before submitting. If the app reports a problem, read the message and check whether the entry already appears before trying again.

Work with assigned sections

The admin can assign sections and questions by caregiver. Two caregivers may see different questions because their work and assignments differ.

- Use the fields you see for topics such as sleep, health, activities, education or learning, and positive observations. If a question you need is missing, ask the admin to review your assignment.
- When a question also measures an ISA outcome, the admin can link it so the same answer can support both the check-in and the outcome record.
- When documenting an activity, describe the support and the person's response. For example, "Jamie chose the library. I helped with the first step at checkout, and Jamie returned the books independently."

Resume an unfinished entry

1. **Open Saved Drafts on the device where you started the check-in and choose the entry to resume.**
2. Check that the date and answers match the entry you meant to complete. Finish and submit it from the check-in screen.
3. Delete a draft from Saved Drafts if you no longer need it.

Before submitting, confirm that the entry describes the correct person and date.

Caregiver | Record support provided and location

Documenting what kind of support occurred and where it happened makes daily records more useful for the team, reports, and service review.

When you complete a check-in

1. Begin a check-in for the correct individual and service date. Find the Support Provided and Location fields in the shift details or relevant assigned section.

2. Choose all support types that apply, if the screen permits multiple selections. Do not select something that was not provided.

3. Choose the location or locations where support actually occurred, if multiple selection is available. Follow the labels in your version of STAR.

4. In the narrative, describe the person's activity, how much help they received, any prompts, and how they responded. Use their exact words when possible and identify them as a quote.

5. Review and submit. Open Reports for the same date to check that the support and location entries were saved and shown accurately.

DRAFT

What a useful note looks like

Example: "Jamie chose to go to the library. I reminded Jamie of the checkout steps and helped with the first step. Jamie returned the books independently and said, 'I want to come again.'"

If the fields are not shown

Ask the administrator to check your assigned questions and whether Supports & Locations is enabled in your STAR environment. Do not insert information into an unrelated field just to force the report.

SCREENSHOT NEEDED — S10: Daily check-in screen showing the Support Provided multi-select and Location multi-select.

SCREENSHOT NEEDED — S11: A saved daily report showing those selected values for the same entry.

Caregiver | Review reports and team tools

For caregivers and administrators. Case managers may use the reports their permissions allow; see the dedicated case-manager section.



Find the record you need

1. Open Reports and choose the date range you want to review. Confirm the individual if the report offers a selector.
2. Choose the relevant report or topic. A daily entry helps you check what was recorded on a particular date. A summary or trend view helps you review a longer period.
3. For ISA progress, open the available ISA report. Review the measure and any linked answers in the same date range. If something you expect is missing, check the original entry, its date, and the caregiver's measure link.

Review How I Feel and My Day responses

In Reports, choose the individual and date range you want to review. Look for the person's My STAR responses alongside caregiver documentation. How I Feel captures the feeling they selected. My Day captures their rating of an activity and the activity name if they shared one. When reviewing the original entry, check whether they marked Someone helped me answer.

If a saved response is missing from the report, check the individual and date range. If the team needs the response in its documentation, use the relevant caregiver check-in note and identify it as the person's own response. Keep any caregiver observations separate.

These check-ins give the team a record of what the person says about how they feel and what they enjoy. For example, if someone repeatedly chooses I liked it after swimming, the team can ask if they want more chances to swim. A Tired response gives the team a reason to ask how the person is doing. If someone skips, leave their response blank.

Use Home and Group Chat

Open Home for Quick Actions. When someone sends a Help Now or Something Hurts alert from My STAR, look for the notification on the caregiver or admin Home dashboard and open Group Chat to read the message and any follow-up details. Confirm the active group before sending a reply.

DRAFT

Use Calendar and Docs

- Calendar shows group events. Select an event to view its details or use the add option to schedule an event if your role allows it.
- Docs groups documents into categories such as medical records, meeting minutes, and guardianship documents. Start by opening the category that matches the file you need.
- Emergency opens the Emergency Sheet with key medical and emergency information for the individual. Admins manage changes to the sheet.

Coordinate priorities and account access

- In Focus of the Week, choose a priority, describe what the team will try, and save it. Return later to review how it went.
- In Profile, check your account and group. Use Group Settings to manage team access if your role allows it.

Example. If a caregiver reports an activity in Chat and the team also wants that activity tracked for an outcome, use the assigned check-in question to record the progress measure.

DRAFT

Caregiver | Find resources and instructions

Open Menu, then Resources. You can also open Docs and tap its Resources card. Tap a section heading to expand it and see its instructions or links.

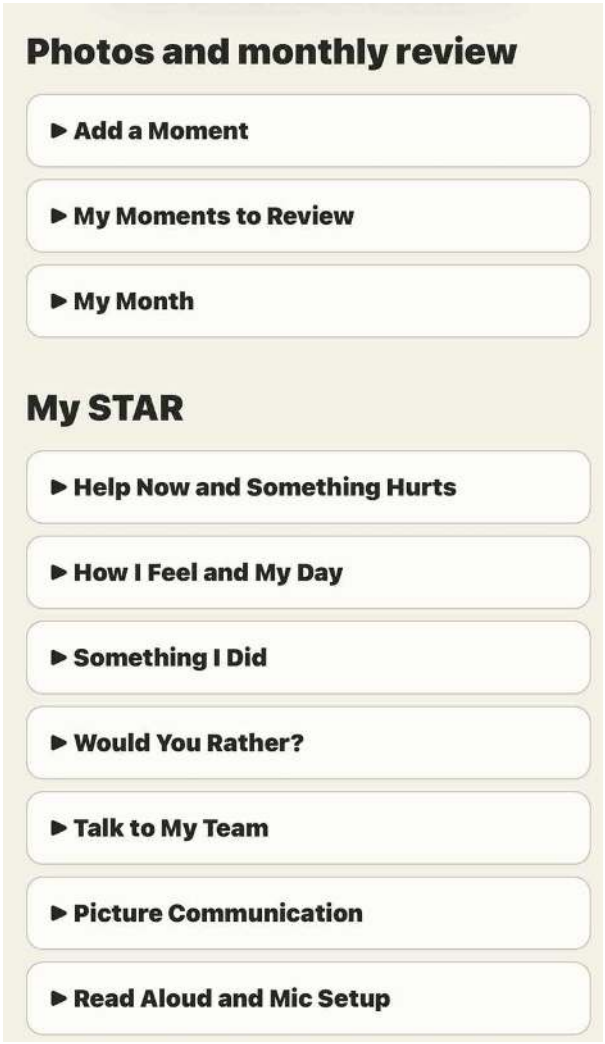


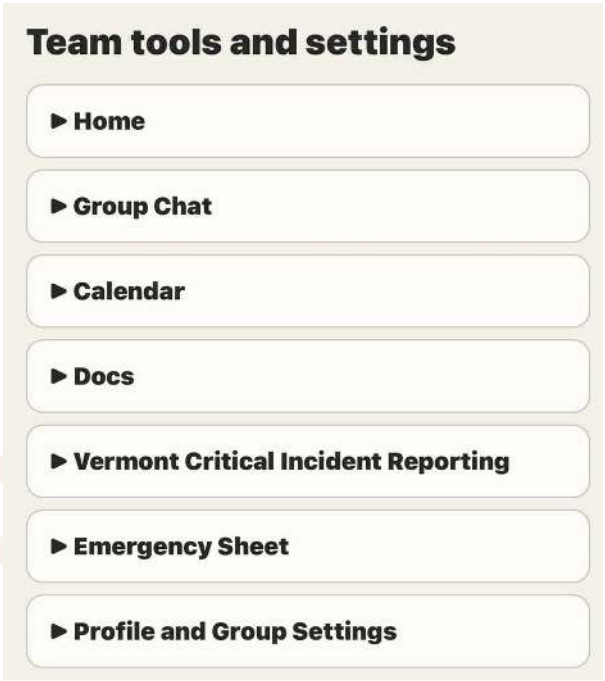
Resources Find ARIS timesheets and reimbursement forms, Vermont phone numbers, role guidance for case managers, QDDPs, DSPs and respite providers, and the printable Who's on your team? worksheet.

Caregiver tools Find instructions for Check-in, Saved Drafts, Reports, ISA Outcomes, and Focus of the Week. Admins can also find guidance on Team Updates, reviewing My STAR observations, and customizing caregiver check-ins.

Caregiver | Find My STAR and team guidance

Continue scrolling in the Feature Guide to find the sections below. Tap a heading to see what the feature does and how to open it. Illustrated instructions for the two communication and support preparation tools are in Part 6.





Photos and monthly review Find Add a Moment, My Moments to Review, and My Month.

My STAR Find help and pain communication, feelings, choices, accomplishments, team communication, and accessibility options.

Team tools and settings Find Home, Group Chat, Calendar, Docs, Vermont Critical Incident Reporting, Emergency Sheet, and Profile and Group Settings.